go so far as to say that all women must be able to stand on their own two feet and not be dependent on the largesse of parents or in-laws.

28 Infantry Brigade had its HQ at Sunderbani, about two hours' drive from Akhnoor on the Akhnoor–Rajouri Road, with its Battalions deployed on the Line of Control (LC). It was commanded by Brig KPN Singh of the Punjab Regiment, a stern no-nonsense kind of man. A teetotaller and a strict vegetarian with frugal habits, work was worship for him. Once I had taken over from the incumbent BM, he called me and told me to visit each and every post in the Brigade Area of Responsibility (AOR) and only then return to the HQ, no matter how long it took. There were 71 such posts in the AOR, from Company, Platoon and Section level posts and even two-man observation posts, some of which could only be visited at night, as the Pakis would fire at us from across the LC. I was taken around and shown each inch of the ground, briefed about our own and enemy plans, and the alignment of the LC, which was inviolate. I also got the opportunity to meet the COs and Company Commanders of the three Battalions, as well as the Adjutants I would be dealing with on a daily basis. Maj YK Joshi of 13 JAK RIF and Maj Asit Mistry of 12 MARATHA LI were two such Company Commanders.[1] Capt A Sengupta of 14 PUNJAB (AKAL SAHAE) was one of the Adjutants.[2] It took me about three weeks to visit all the posts, mostly on foot, staying overnight at some of them, observing the Pakistani side and their movement patterns. Laleali, the forward-most Company location, where Joshi (Jo) was located, was one of the most vital locations in the divisional sector, from where one could get a clear view of the entire Chhamb plains. If only Laleali had been able to observe those mysterious lights I had seen back in 1984, when deployed at Sangam, it would have saved us a lot of trouble.

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